

James Privett

EXPERIENCED ENGINEERING TEAM LEADER

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ABOUT

Experienced Engineering Team Lead & Software Engineer. Extremely data-driven and customer-focused with a proven track record in building happy, healthy teams that deliver high-quality output against tight deadlines. As a skilled People Manager, Mentor & Coach, I consistently assemble healthier, more productive and fulfilled engineers, finding the right opportunities for them leading to multiple promotions. I'm highly organised and use excellent communication skills to build collaborative teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

LEAD ENGINEER MAR 2020 – PRESENT *Unmind / London*

- Leading multiple engineering teams, which allowed me to have a deep knowledge of all aspects of the engineering team.. Supporting my engineers' personal career development, helping them to stay happy, healthy and motivated in their role leading to better code quality, authentic retrospects and radical candour.
- Responsible for building three new teams to create a brand nascent data platform and client reporting dashboard, allowing Unmind to reduce time overhead by successfully tracking multiple business metrics in a single, centralised repository.
- Being proactive in addressing any underperformance, and handling it with utmost care and consideration for all involved helping maintain the psychological safety I have created with my teams.
- Stakeholder management included working with Product Managers, Designers, External Stakeholders and Engineers regularly to identify and mitigate bottlenecks.
- Utilise development, delivery and health metrics to inform the effectiveness of my team's ways of working and overall performance.
- Overseeing hiring, team moves and onboarding processes. Proactively identifying team requirements and changing needs ensuring our engineers have the skill set required for upcoming initiatives.
- Balancing the needs of both the individuals I manage and the business recognising when to step in and when to give space, and being able to empower and delegate.
- Creating an inclusive, collaborative and supportive culture for engineers, helping them take their performance from good to great.

FULL STACK ENGINEER NOV 2017 – MAR 2020 *Unmind / London*

- As the first engineer at Unmind, I was responsible for creating the foundations of a company's system architecture that enabled them to raise millions to build the company. . They remain the only part of our codebase not to be rewritten.
- Developed the REST API that ran the first versions of the app
- I then transferred the REST API to GraphQL, sharing my knowledge to upskill other developers and removing the need for external training.
- While Rebranding the platform post-funding, I helped modernised the platform using ReactJS.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER - CONTRACTOR APR 2015 – OCT 2017 *MaisyWeb / Brighton*

Projects Include

- **Polestar Payroll:** Single-handedly built a fully managed payroll service that ensures its clients that payroll is processed correctly and on time and that it complies with the ever-changing payroll legislation. Built using a combination of Coldfusion, SQL Server, Javascript, this secure platform paid over 10,000 personnel.
- **Innerplace:** A luxury concierge service in London that offers its members the desired lifestyle. I set up the website using Mura CMS, which gives the Innerplace team total control over the site's content. I also built the backend CRM system that powers the members, member requests and social events engine. Integrates with Stripe, Trengo, Trello, Mailchimp and Mandrill.
- **Exec Secure:** A self-service tool that makes secure and safe transportation readily available and easily booked. The website and management console are built predominantly with ColdFusion and MySQL. Integrates with Stripe, Mailchimp and Mandrill.

LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER APR 2013 – APR 2015 *Compare and Share / Brighton*

- Developed an aggregation platform working with over 30 parent APIs. The result was a search engine that allowed users to search over 3M records.
- Worked closely with the founding team to implement various design choices to ensure the product meet its core requirements.
- Engineered the product from concept to MVP and finally to a fully operational platform.
- Worked with a data science agency to allow a dynamic search engine that would update depending on data ingested from the APIs. Search speeds went from a few seconds to sub 0.5 seconds.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER JAN 2009 – APR 2013 *Tizuni / Brighton*

- Ensuring delivery of multiple projects to various clients, including the NHS, BBC, Chanel 4 and Corvoisuiet.
- Working in an agency environment, we often had very tight timeframes, so I worked negotiating the scope to deliver the most efficient code to meet the needs of the business.
- Focused on building new features to our in-house CRM to vastly improve the platform's offerings to create an ultra-fast and responsive experience for content creators.
- Simultaneously liaising with clients, engineers and designers across multiple projects.

EDUCATION

BHASVIC MAY 1996 *GNVQ Advanced Business Studies: Distinction, Brighton*

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

LEADERSHIP

People Management · People Development · Coaching · Mentoring · Effective Communication · Emotional Intelligence · Delegation Skills · Agile Methodologies

FAMILIAR WITH

Javascript · React · GraphQL · Restful web services · AWS ecosystem · Jira · ColdFusion · MURA CMS · Wordpress · HTML · CSS · jQuery

DATABASES

MySQL · SQL Server · Postgres

LEARNING, INTERESTS & EXPERIMENTING

Typescript · React Native · Product Management · Blockchain · Machine Learning